1950 treaty made Sikkim an Indian protectorate, with India responsible for external affairs, defence and strategic communications. [26]

There was also the matter of non-British colonial possessions in India. These included two French colonies, Chandernagore and Pondicherry (which also encompassed three other enclaves: Karaikal surrounded by today's Tamil Nadu, Yanam abutting Andhra Pradesh, and Mahé next to Kerala). In 1949, Chandernagore voted overwhelmingly to join India, which it did de facto, and by the early 1950s Pondicherry saw protests in favour of a merger with India. In 1954, Chandernagore officially became a part of West Bengal and Pondicherry became a Union Territory, with the transition of power in the former French colonies completed following treaty ratification by the French Parliament in 1962. [27]

Additionally, Portugal had the colonies of Goa, Daman and Diu, and Dadra and Nagar Haveli. The latter was taken over by pro-India groups in 1954, but Goa, Daman, and Diu remained in Portuguese hands until 1961. India faced mounting criticism both at home and abroad for tolerating continued colonialism at its doorstep. Portugal, for its part, felt that its presence in the North Atlantic Treaty Organization (NATO) alliance would deter Indian military force. On 18 December 1961, amid considerable diplomatic wrangling, support from across the Indian political spectrum, and a looming General Election, Operation Vijay was launched. This involved coordinated Indian army, air force, and navy operations against Goa, Daman and Diu and resulted in a Portuguese surrender on 19 December. The liberation of Goa was not a peaceful one: both sides suffered military fatalities. Portugal only accepted their former colonial possessions—including Dadra and Nagar Haveli—as belonging to India after a 1974 coup (the Carnation Revolution) that transitioned that country into a democracy and accelerated decolonization efforts. [28]

Clever Calf: The Economy and the Cold War, 1947–1965

Beyond the immediate question of the territoriality and unity of the country, independent India's leaders had to grapple with pressing questions